

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Jahangir & the Early Seventeenth Century (Nur Jahan) - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Jahangir & the Early Seventeenth Century (Nur Jahan)	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01 REIGN FRAME: CONTINUITY, CONSOLIDATION AND CONTEST The Mewar settlement process of 1613-15 and Kangra's capture in	02 EARLY ORDERS, JUSTICE AND POLITICAL LANGUAGE The <i>zanjir-i adl</i> , or chain of justice, is best read the same way.
03 KHUSRAU'S REVOLT: A SUCCESSION CRISIS IN A PUNJAB FIELD The relevant field was the route north-west towards Punjab and	04 GURU ARJAN: SOURCE CRITICISM BEFORE A VERDICT Sikh traditions preserve the community's memory of Guru Arjan's
05 MEWAR, 1613-15: PRESSURE, HONOUR AND ACCOMMODATION Rana Amar Singh was excused personal attendance at court, an	06 KANGRA, EASTERN CONSOLIDATION AND BOUNDED FRONTIERS Technically, Kangra, eastern consolidation and bounded frontiers is
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15 GOVERNING, RELIGION AND PERSONAL REPUTATION Technically, Governing, religion and personal reputation is analysed	16 SOURCES, HISTORIOGRAPHY AND A GRADED VERDICT Technically, Sources, historiography and a graded verdict is analysed
17 BOUNDED LIVE LINKAGE The live page is a heritage and source-method bridge only.	

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Jahangir & the Early Seventeenth Century (Nur Jahan) - Complete Topic Package

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Learning MCQs - 18 original questions

The option sequence is deliberately rotated. Each explanation identifies the factual discriminator and the closest attractive error.

Q1. Which framing best describes Jahangir's reign?

- A. Institutional continuity with consolidation and serious court/frontier contests
- B. A uniformly peaceful continuation of Akbar
- C. A complete break from Akbar's polity
- D. Automatic decline from 1605

Answer: A. The reign continued Akbar's institutional inheritance, yet Khusrau, Qandahar, Khurram and Mahabat show why 'peaceful continuity' is the closest but still inadequate lure.

Q2. What can the Jahangirnama's twelve orders establish most securely?

- A. That later folklore lists are all authentic
- B. That Jahangir publicly represented an early programme of regulation
- C. That a modern written constitution replaced discretion
- D. That every order was uniformly implemented across the empire

Answer: B. The memoir is direct evidence of programme and self-presentation; empire-wide enforcement is the specific extra claim the source cannot carry by itself.

Q3. The chain of justice is best used as evidence for

- A. A surviving register of equal remedies
- B. An elected judicial institution
- C. A ruler-centred claim of accessibility and justice
- D. A universal right to bypass officials

Answer: C. Its gold-and-bell image stages royal accessibility. The tempting universal-access option confuses a sovereign symbol with documented egalitarian procedure.

Q4. Khusrau's revolt of 1606 should first be analysed as

- A. A later Mughal war of succession after 1627
- B. A Portuguese attack on Surat
- C. An instant empire-wide religious war
- D. A princely succession challenge using Punjab political networks

Answer: D. The central discriminator is date and actor: Khusrau was Jahangir's son and the episode was an early-reign political challenge, not a later or maritime conflict.

Q5. Why must Guru Arjan's execution be treated with source caution?

- A. Jahangir's memoir gives an imperial accusation but does not settle every motive
- B. Only a fiscal penalty is mentioned in all sources
- C. Sikh traditions are irrelevant to the event
- D. The event had no political context

Answer: A. Jahangirnama is crucial for the imperial framing; the closest error treats that courtly claim as a final explanation and excludes Sikh memory.

Q6. The 1615 Mewar arrangement included

- A. Mewar's recovery of complete external independence
- B. Mughal suzerainty while excusing Rana Amar Singh's personal attendance
- C. A compulsory Mughal-Rana matrimonial alliance
- D. Outright annexation and removal of the Sisodia dynasty

Answer: B. The settlement's distinctive balance was subordination with honour. The annexation option misses Karan Singh's incorporation and the continued Rana house.

Q7. Kangra's 1620 capture most safely demonstrates

- A. Automatic administration of all Himalayan polities
- B. The recovery of Qandahar from the Safavids
- C. Strategic and symbolic consolidation through a fort
- D. A decisive Deccan settlement with Malik Ambar

Answer: C. A fort mattered for prestige and routes; the nearest overclaim converts a fortress capture into a total regional map.

Q8. William Hawkins is best described as

- A. A governor who ruled Surat for the English crown
- B. A Safavid ambassador sent to recover Qandahar
- C. A Mughal mansabdar commanding Mewar
- D. An English Company representative seeking Mughal trading access

Answer: D. Hawkins's court experience belongs to petitioning English trade. The Surat-ruler distractor projects later colonial power back onto the early seventeenth century.

Q9. Roe's 1615-19 embassy shows that the English were

- A. Suppliant merchants/diplomats negotiating within Mughal sovereignty
- B. Equal sovereign allies controlling Gujarat
- C. Portuguese officers appointed by Jahangir
- D. Already territorial rulers of India

Answer: A. Roe sought facilities and status; the closest lure is equality, but his complaints themselves show he did not set Mughal terms.

Q10. The 1618 farman should NOT be described as

- A. A limited basis for commercial access
- B. A grant of English territorial sovereignty
- C. A document to be read with factory practice
- D. A cautiously framed trading facility

Answer: B. No farman gave the Company land-based sovereignty or an empire-wide monopoly. Calling it a trading facility is careful rather than dismissive.

Q11. Nur Jahan's farmans and coins most directly demonstrate

- A. General political equality for Mughal women
- B. That Jahangir ceased to rule permanently
- C. Exceptional formal public authority alongside household influence
- D. That all noble promotions came from one family

Answer: C. Material documents make authority visible. The closest overreach is sovereign replacement; documents prove particular formal authority, not total control.

Q12. The Itimad-ud-Daulah tomb is strongest evidence for

- A. A dated 2026 conservation announcement

- B. Jahangir's tomb in Agra
- C. A permanent Nur Jahan-Khurram alliance
- D. Family commemoration and architectural patronage linked to Nur Jahan

Answer: D. The monument anchors patronage and Ghiyas Beg's commemoration; it cannot prove a factional alliance, and Jahangir's tomb is in Lahore.

Q13. Beni Prasad's 'junta' thesis is challenged because

- A. Promotions and alliances do not demonstrate a fixed bloc from 1611-20
- B. Nur Jahan's family never rose at court
- C. No household politics existed in Mughal rule
- D. Khurram had no service career

Answer: A. The revisionist point is not family irrelevance but the absence of proof for a stable four-person coalition across the whole early period.

Q14. A useful post-1622 reading of court politics stresses

- A. A completed Deccan annexation
- B. Crisis-driven realignment amid Qandahar, illness and succession
- C. An unchanged alliance since 1611
- D. The disappearance of all noble networks

Answer: B. The time boundary matters: after 1622 pressures sharpened. The fixed-alliance distractor erases the very chronology the historiographical debate requires.

Q15. Khurram's rebellion is best explained by

- A. Only a Portuguese naval defeat
- B. Only a religious policy dispute
- C. Succession insecurity, resources, Qandahar and court competition together
- D. Only Nur Jahan's personal hostility

Answer: C. Several connected pressures explain the rebellion. The personal-hostility answer is deliberately tempting but replaces structural politics with one-cause drama.

Q16. Mahabat Khan's coup reveals that

- A. An emperor's capture automatically transferred every institution
- B. The Mughal empire instantly ended in 1626
- C. Rajput troops had no role in the episode
- D. Seizing the emperor gave leverage without securing the whole state

Answer: D. The coup's short life exposes the gap between bodily custody and command of treasury, bureaucracy, legitimacy and broad noble support.

Q17. Which assessment of Jahangir's religious policy is most defensible?

- A. Broad continuity with Akbar alongside contextual coercive episodes
- B. A policy unrelated to political context
- C. A complete restoration of jizyah and exclusion
- D. A simple tolerant ruler with no coercion

Answer: A. The composite-nobility framework and no jizyah restoration matter, but Guru Arjan prevents a flattering no-coercion story.

Q18. The best use of the Jahangirnama is to

- A. Use it only for European trade
- B. Read it for chronology and representation while testing claims against other evidence
- C. Treat every royal claim as transparent social fact

- D. Reject it because it is royal

Answer: B. Source criticism preserves the memoir's value and limits. The closest bad practice is accepting the chain of orders as proof of universal reality.

Broad MCQs - 40 original questions

The option sequence is deliberately rotated. Each explanation identifies the factual discriminator and the closest attractive error.

Q19. Salim's separate court before accession should be used as

- A. a reason to ignore the 1605 accession settlement
- B. proof that Akbar's administration ended before 1605
- C. bounded evidence of pre-accession tension, not a fixed personality diagnosis
- D. evidence that Salim never negotiated with nobles

Answer: C. A separate court signals real tension. The diagnosis distractor is closest because it illegitimately turns a political episode into certain inner character.

Q20. The term 'Padshah' in accession context principally signals

- A. a provincial revenue post
- B. a European factory privilege
- C. a modern elected office
- D. imperial sovereignty and ceremonial legitimacy

Answer: D. Titulary stages rank and sovereignty. The provincial-office option confuses court language with an administrative post.

Q21. A claim of clemency in a royal memoir should be checked against

- A. the episode's wider record, recipients and implementation
- B. only a later tourist description
- C. the assumption that all clemency was equal
- D. a numerical vote of nobles

Answer: A. Clemency is a rulerly claim and action whose reach needs contextual evidence; the equality assumption is the nearest modern projection.

Q22. Why was Lahore/Punjab important in the Khusrau episode?

- A. it was a Portuguese base controlling Surat
- B. It was a political-military field along the rebel's north-west movement
- C. it was Jahangir's permanent mausoleum site in 1606
- D. it lay inside the Deccan campaign zone

Answer: B. Punjab connected succession politics to movement and support. The tomb lure mixes the later burial association with the revolt.

Q23. Jahangir's record of Guru Arjan can securely show

- A. the later Sikh military organisation
- B. a neutral community census
- C. the emperor's stated grounds and decision to punish
- D. the private intentions of every actor

Answer: C. A ruler's memoir records his framing and order. It cannot transparently supply private motive or later institutional history.

Q24. The word 'suzerainty' in the Mewar settlement means

- A. complete provincial annexation
- B. a relation with no political obligations

- C. a federation of equal states
- D. an unequal superior claim alongside retained internal dynasty

Answer: D. Suzerainty is the middle category students often lose: stronger than courtesy, less than wholesale annexation.

Q25. Karan Singh's reception at court illustrates

- A. service-linked integration and honourable incorporation
- B. Roe's embassy protocol
- C. the extinction of the Sisodia line
- D. Safavid control of Chittor

Answer: A. Karan Singh makes the Mewar settlement concrete. The closest false choice, extinction, contradicts the retained Rana house.

Q26. A restriction on rebuilding Chittor's fortifications would most likely signify

- A. a Kangra treaty term
- B. an imperial memory of victory and a limit on military restoration
- C. a Company right to garrison the fort
- D. a grant of full military independence

Answer: B. The restriction marks asymmetry and the memory of Chittor; it cannot be inverted into a sovereignty grant.

Q27. The best generalisation about Jahangir's eastern policy is

- A. European factories controlled the east
- B. all eastern politics were identical to Mewar
- C. consolidation remained a process involving regional and Afghan challenges
- D. Bengal and Orissa ceased to need governance after conquest

Answer: C. The process language avoids a finality myth. The Mewar comparison distractor ignores different regional political structures.

Q28. Malik Ambar in this topic chiefly functions as

- A. the leader of the 1606 Khusrau revolt
- B. the Safavid governor of Qandahar
- C. the English envoy who obtained the 1618 farman
- D. a reminder of the limits of Mughal Deccan consolidation

Answer: D. Malik Ambar anchors the unfinished Deccan; detailed operations are intentionally owned by Topic 18.

Q29. The 1622 Qandahar loss cautions against

- A. equating diplomatic cordiality with frontier readiness
- B. studying Safavid-Mughal relations
- C. using Qandahar as a strategic node
- D. noting court coordination problems

Answer: A. Gift exchange and cordial words did not secure a fort. The closest wrong option says diplomacy itself should be ignored rather than qualified.

Q30. Swally/Suvali is relevant because

- A. it made the English sovereign over Gujarat
- B. maritime balance affected English petitions in the Surat world
- C. it was the site of Mewar's settlement
- D. it ended Portuguese maritime power everywhere

Answer: B. A local naval context altered bargaining without conferring land sovereignty or ending all Portuguese power.

Q31. A factory record is especially useful for

- A. a complete neutral account of Mughal society
- B. the exact content of every Persian chronicle
- C. commercial practice and a merchant's operational perspective
- D. the internal motives of Nur Jahan

Answer: C. Factory records see trade and permissions well; the whole-society option is the closest scope error.

Q32. Gift disputes in Roe's journal tell us about

- A. the abolition of Mughal hierarchy
- B. the end of merchant rivalry
- C. a modern treaty-ratification procedure
- D. rank, reception and diplomatic culture as political practice

Answer: D. Gifts and audience protocol carried rank claims. The treaty distractor imports modern diplomatic law.

Q33. Which is a sound statement about early English access?

- A. It was contingent on Mughal permissions and local commercial conditions
- B. It eliminated Indian merchants from Surat
- C. It guaranteed a territorial empire
- D. It gave an exclusive monopoly over Indian Ocean trade

Answer: A. Contingency captures the 1610s situation; territorial or monopoly formulations telescope later changes backward.

Q34. Ghiyas Beg is important because he was

- A. the Rana of Mewar in 1615
- B. Nur Jahan's father, later titled Itimad-ud-Daulah
- C. Mahabat Khan's Rajput commander
- D. Jahangir's English ambassador

Answer: B. Family identification anchors the tomb and court network. The Mewar lure swaps entirely different political fields.

Q35. Asaf Khan matters to succession analysis because

- A. he commanded the 1612 English fleet
- B. he was Guru Arjan's successor
- C. his daughter Arjumand Banu married Khurram
- D. he was a Safavid shah

Answer: C. The marriage link explains a household channel, not an automatic fixed faction.

Q36. A title such as Nur Mahal/Nur Jahan should be handled by

- A. equating it with a mansab rank
- B. assuming the title created a modern monarchy
- C. discarding all title evidence
- D. checking chronology and source rather than treating it as a constitutional office

Answer: D. Titles are meaningful public markers, but not automatically modern offices or mansab positions.

Q37. Why are coins especially useful in assessing Nur Jahan?

- A. They provide material, public evidence of a named authority formula

- B. they eliminate the need for dates
- C. they record every private conversation
- D. they prove she alone commanded the army

Answer: A. Coins are independent material evidence, yet their circulation/formula must still be dated and cannot become a total-control claim.

Q38. A patronage attribution is strongest when supported by

- A. a romantic court tale without provenance
- B. a surviving monument, inscription, document or secure contemporary record
- C. a title alone
- D. a circulating internet list

Answer: B. Material or documentary provenance ranks above repetition. The court-tale lure is precisely why evidence hierarchy is needed.

Q39. Itimad-ud-Daulah's tomb is located in

- A. Lahore as Jahangir's own tomb
- B. Ajmer as the Mewar campaign headquarters
- C. Agra, on the Yamuna-side heritage landscape
- D. Surat as the English factory

Answer: C. Agra is the tomb's site; Lahore is the separate burial geography of Jahangir.

Q40. The central problem with the fixed-junta thesis is

- A. it notes Khurram's military service
- B. it dates Jahangir's accession to 1605
- C. it acknowledges family patronage
- D. it converts shifting networks into a permanent four-person bloc

Answer: D. Family rise is genuine, so the problem is rigidity rather than the mere recognition of kinship.

Q41. Nurul Hasan's critique directs attention to

- A. distribution of promotions and absence of proof for a stable alliance
- B. the annexation of Mewar
- C. only European trade data
- D. the denial of all court faction

Answer: A. The critique is empirical and networked, not a claim that court politics disappeared.

Q42. Why is 1622 a useful turning point for Nur Jahan's politics?

- A. it ends Jahangir's reign
- B. Multiple crises made access, succession and alignment more consequential
- C. it is the date of Mewar's settlement
- D. it marks her 1611 marriage

Answer: B. The date clusters Qandahar, household loss and Khurram's rupture; marriage and death belong to other dates.

Q43. Shahryar's political significance sharpened because of

- A. his role as James I's envoy
- B. his capture of Qandahar
- C. his marriage to Ladli Begum and the succession field
- D. his command of Kangra in 1620

Answer: C. The marriage link mattered in succession calculations; the other roles belong to different actors/events.

Q44. Khurram's Deccan/Mewar service should be read as

- A. proof that he had already become emperor
- B. a reason Qandahar no longer mattered
- C. evidence that court politics ended
- D. a source of stature that did not guarantee succession

Answer: D. Military success bolstered claims but succession remained contested, as the later rebellion itself demonstrates.

Q45. Jagir/resource disputes matter in the Khurram crisis because

- A. they linked rank, military capacity and political bargaining
- B. they were unrelated to princes
- C. they gave English merchants sovereignty
- D. they replaced all kinship ties

Answer: A. Resources were political in a service monarchy. The closest wrong option makes money the only cause and erases succession/kinship.

Q46. A 'one-cause' narrative of Khurram's revolt fails because

- A. all sources agree on one motive
- B. command, succession, resources and court alignments interacted
- C. the rebellion did not occur
- D. Qandahar had no connection to court politics

Answer: B. Interaction is the explanatory gain; the all-sources option is false precisely because evidence and motives are contested.

Q47. Mahabat Khan's account-related grievance should be treated as

- A. a Mewar settlement term
- B. a fully documented private emotion
- C. a reported political grievance requiring source and faction context
- D. an English trading regulation

Answer: C. Grievance language comes through partisan narratives. The private-emotion lure asks sources to do more than they can.

Q48. The Jhelum setting mattered to Mahabat's coup because

- A. it placed the emperor at the Surat coast
- B. it was within Chittor fort
- C. it was a stable fixed capital court
- D. a river crossing created a moment of movement and vulnerability

Answer: D. A travelling river crossing could be exploited. The fixed-capital option erases the tactical opportunity.

Q49. The Rajput contingent in the 1626 coup shows

- A. service networks could be used in a noble's immediate coercion
- B. all Rajput houses held one permanent position
- C. Mewar had been annexed
- D. the emperor lacked any legitimacy

Answer: A. A contingent shows a specific service connection, not a monolithic Rajput bloc or a total collapse of imperial legitimacy.

Q50. Nur Jahan's recovery from the coup depended in part on

- A. English military intervention

- B. manoeuvring within legitimacy and detaching support from Mahabat
- C. the instant disappearance of Jahangir
- D. a guaranteed constitutional office

Answer: B. Her leverage was relational and political; a constitutional-office story imports a structure the court did not possess.

Q51. Why did Mahabat's seizure not endure?

- A. the emperor's person had no political value
- B. the coup happened after Jahangir's death
- C. He lacked durable control over administration, treasury and broad nobles
- D. all troops immediately changed sides

Answer: C. Custody mattered greatly, but it was insufficient. The no-value choice reverses the lesson about embodied sovereignty.

Q52. No restoration of jizyah under Jahangir helps establish

- A. a modern secular constitution
- B. the absence of all coercive episodes
- C. an English commercial monopoly
- D. continuity with Akbar's broad fiscal-religious framework

Answer: D. This is a useful institutional fact, but it cannot erase individual coercive episodes or create anachronistic secularism.

Q53. Jahangir's natural-history observations are best read as

- A. part of a memoir's observing and self-fashioning rulerly persona
- B. a Company shipping log
- C. evidence that he did not govern
- D. a modern scientific survey with no genre bias

Answer: A. Observation has real evidentiary value, yet genre and imperial self-presentation remain active.

Q54. A Mughal court painting most directly preserves

- A. the full text of a farman
- B. a visual construction of hierarchy, taste and imperial ideology
- C. a camera-like record of every event
- D. a modern census

Answer: B. Paintings are highly valuable but representational. The camera lure is the exact source-method error.

Q55. The word 'continuation' in relation to the Jahangirnama alerts us to

- A. the end of Persian chronicles
- B. a European translation monopoly
- C. later textual layers beyond Jahangir's own composed portions
- D. the claim that Jahangir wrote nothing

Answer: C. The memoir has an imperial authorial core and later transmission/continuation issues; neither wholesale rejection nor total transparency follows.

Q56. Mutamad Khan's Iqbalnama should be used as

- A. a legal code enacted by Roe
- B. an English factory journal
- C. a substitute for all evidence
- D. a Persian chronicle to compare with memoir and material sources

Answer: D. Comparison is the point: court chronicles offer sequence and rhetoric but have patronage and perspective.

Q57. A source-conscious use of Jahangir's health is to

- A. connect it cautiously to access and crisis politics without asserting permanent abdication
- B. ignore all references to health as irrelevant
- C. use it to date the Mewar settlement to 1622
- D. treat illness as proof that every decision was Nur Jahan's

Answer: A. Health can alter access and political opportunity, but the closest lure converts that possibility into a total-transfer-of-rule claim unsupported by the record.

Q58. Which overall verdict is best supported by the reign's evidence?

- A. An English territorial state created by the Surat farman
- B. A governing emperor and exceptional consort in an unevenly consolidating empire
- C. A collapsed empire ruled only by a junta from 1611
- D. A peaceful reign with no frontier or succession stress

Answer: B. This verdict holds Mewar/Kangra, Qandahar, rebellion, documents and source limits together; each alternative elevates one familiar story into an absolute.

Remedial MCQs - 12 original questions

The option sequence is deliberately rotated. Each explanation identifies the factual discriminator and the closest attractive error.

Q59. Which phrase corrects the 'decline from 1605' shortcut?

- A. Immediate systemic collapse
- B. A total break with Akbar
- C. Inherited institutions plus uneven consolidation and real stress
- D. A reign without challenges

Answer: C. Mewar and Kangra make collapse untenable, while Qandahar and revolt make a no-challenge story equally inaccurate.

Q60. The chain of justice was NOT

- A. a memoir-described public object
- B. part of Jahangir's justice persona
- C. a royal symbol of accessibility
- D. a demonstrated modern system of equal access to courts

Answer: D. The anachronism is converting a ruler-centred claim into an impersonal equal-rights system.

Q61. What is unsafe about a one-cause Guru Arjan explanation?

- A. It turns competing political, religious and fiscal evidence into certainty
- B. It asks for chronology
- C. It uses Sikh tradition
- D. It notices Jahangir's memoir

Answer: A. The problem is certainty beyond source reach, not the use of any one source when it is clearly identified.

Q62. The Mewar settlement was not

- A. an arrangement protecting Rana honour
- B. a straightforward annexation that erased the Rana house
- C. a setting for Karan Singh's incorporation
- D. an acceptance of Mughal suzerainty

Answer: B. The Sisodia dynasty and internal space remained; 'annexation' destroys the settlement's negotiated character.

Q63. Roe's trading facilities did not grant

- A. Mughal-term commercial access
- B. a reason to study protocol
- C. territorial sovereignty to the English Company
- D. a contingent Surat position

Answer: C. The future-colonial lure is teleology: commercial permission in the 1610s was not sovereignty.

Q64. Why is 'fixed junta' an unsafe answer?

- A. It names a historiographical model
- B. It invites evidence testing
- C. It acknowledges family advancement
- D. It treats fluid 1611-20 networks as a proven permanent coalition

Answer: D. The named model is useful only when paired with the critique; permanence is the unsupported step.

Q65. Nur Jahan's authority did not amount to

- A. automatic sovereign replacement of Jahangir
- B. documentary visibility
- C. exceptional public authority
- D. household-patronage leverage

Answer: A. Farmans and coins prove unusual authority, but they cannot alone convert influence into sole kingship.

Q66. The romance/murder story fails method because

- A. widowhood precedes the 1611 marriage
- B. it substitutes sensational narrative for dated corroborated evidence
- C. titles need chronology
- D. family biography matters

Answer: B. Biography is important; unsupported melodrama is not evidence of political causation.

Q67. Khurram did not rebel for

- A. resource/jagir concerns
- B. succession anxiety
- C. one personal reason detached from command, resources and succession
- D. court competition

Answer: C. A multi-causal political crisis cannot be reduced to a single person or grievance.

Q68. Mahabat's coup did not prove

- A. that the emperor's body had political value
- B. that wider institutions mattered
- C. that noble networks could be coercive
- D. that the empire ceased to exist in 1626

Answer: D. Its reversal demonstrates the state was more than physical custody of its monarch.

Q69. Jahangir was neither simply tolerant nor simply bigoted because

- A. broad continuity coexisted with contextual coercive episodes
- B. politics never shaped coercion
- C. jizyah was restored

- D. all religious policy was uniform

Answer: A. The binary fails to handle both composite governance and specific coercion in their political contexts.

Q70. A memoir is not transparent fact because

- A. it is always false
- B. genre, self-fashioning and silence shape what it can prove
- C. it cannot be compared
- D. it has no chronology value

Answer: B. Source criticism limits and preserves use; wholesale disbelief is no better than uncritical acceptance.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

PART IX - PYQ AUDIT, LEARNING LOOP AND EXAM PRACTICE

Verified PYQ audit and route transparency

The local official/OCR papers and routing material covering 2018-2025 were searched for direct CSE Prelims and GS-I items on Jahangir, Nur Jahan, Khusrav, Guru Arjan, the Mewar settlement, Thomas Roe/Hawkins, Mahabat Khan, the chain of justice, the Tuzuk, and Itimad-ud-Daulah. No direct verified item was located. Broad questions on Mughal painting, architecture, economy or later Sikh history are not silently reassigned to this topic. Therefore there is no fabricated 'exact PYQ' or unofficial key in this package. The practice below is original and clearly labelled.

PART X - EXAMINER-GRADE MAINS PRACTICE WITH SOLUTIONS

The ten original models are deliberately distributed across 10, 15 and 20 marks. Each uses directive fidelity and the pattern claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

Mains 1. Continuity and consolidation - 10 marks

Question: Assess the proposition that Jahangir's reign was more a phase of consolidation than of decline. Answer in 150 words.

Model solution

Directive and thesis. 'Assess' requires a qualified balance. Jahangir inherited Akbar's composite ruling class and did not dismantle the institutional frame; his reign is therefore better read as consolidation under pressure than automatic decline.

Claim -> evidence -> analysis. The 1615 Mewar settlement is decisive evidence. Rana Amar Singh accepted Mughal suzerainty, while exemption from personal attendance and the reception of Karan Singh protected Sisodia honour. This converted a chronic Rajput frontier into a more workable unequal accommodation, showing that imperial authority could use status rather than annexation. The capture of Kangra in 1620 similarly demonstrated strategic and symbolic capacity. The continuity of composite nobility and absence of jizyah restoration reinforce an inherited governing framework.

Qualification. Consolidation was uneven. Malik Ambar limited Mughal Deccan aims; Qandahar fell to the Safavids in 1622; Khurram's rebellion and Mahabat Khan's 1626 coup exposed succession and court vulnerabilities. These are not minor incidents, but they do not prove that Jahangir abdicated or that institutions vanished.

Verdict. The reign consolidated key relationships and territories while revealing the costs of incomplete frontiers and personalised succession politics.

Why this earns marks: It directly weighs the proposition, uses Mewar, Kangra, policy continuity and counter-evidence, and concludes with a graded rather than celebratory verdict.

Continuity versus decline: the right frame



Akbar's composite elite and institutions continued



Mewar and Kangra show consolidation



Qandahar, Deccan and succession expose limits

Visual 3: deterministic revision graphic | Facts and analytical cautions are distinguished in adjacent text.

Visual 3: Continuity versus decline: the right frame

Visual 3: Continuity versus decline: the right frame. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 2. Khusrau and Guru Arjan - 15 marks

Question: Discuss the political and religious dimensions of the 1606 Khusrau revolt and Guru Arjan's execution. Answer in 200 words.

Model solution

Directive and thesis. The question asks for dimensions, not a single cause. The two events were connected by an early succession crisis, but their relationship must be reconstructed through unequal sources.

Political dimension. Khusrau's movement toward the Punjab-Lahore field challenged a newly installed emperor and could attract nobles and local support. Jahangir's suppression was therefore a performance of dynastic authority. The revolt confirms that accession did not mechanically settle elite loyalty.

Evidence and religious dimension. Jahangirnama represents Guru Arjan as a religious figure with followers who had, in the emperor's account, marked or assisted Khusrau; it records an imperial decision to punish him. This is strong evidence for imperial suspicion and rulerly justification. Sikh traditions are equally essential for the community's memory of martyrdom. Political challenge, religious suspicion and fiscal/confiscatory language can all be relevant; none authorises a monocausal verdict.

Qualification. The execution became a turning point in Mughal-Sikh relations, but it did not instantly create the later fully militarised Sikh conflict. That later development needs a separate chronology.

Verdict. 1606 shows how a dynastic emergency could make religious authority politically legible to the court, while source criticism prevents communal reductionism.

Why this earns marks: It answers both dimensions, names Jahangirnama and Sikh traditions, distinguishes source reach, and avoids importing later Sikh history into 1606.

Guru Arjan: source reach matrix

Source	Records	Can support	Cannot alone prove
Jahangirnama	imperial allegation / decision	representation, reported order	not full motive
Sikh tradition	martyrdom/community memory	meaning and remembrance	not a neutral court file
Later chronicles	courtly mediation	sequence/comparison	patronage/retrospection

Visual 10: deterministic study visual | Labels are explanatory; use adjacent text for source limits.

Visual 10: Guru Arjan: source reach matrix

Visual 10: Guru Arjan: source reach matrix. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 3. Mewar settlement - 10 marks

Question: Why was the Mewar settlement of 1615 politically durable? Answer in 150 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The 1615 settlement endured because it combined Mughal superiority with a carefully designed protection of Sisodia honour; it was neither equality nor simple annexation.

Evidence -> analysis. Jahangir intensified pressure through the 1613-15 campaign under Prince Khurram after prior efforts had not produced a settlement. Rana Amar Singh accepted Mughal suzerainty, demonstrating an unequal imperial outcome. Yet the Rana was excused personal attendance at court, while Karan Singh was received and honoured in imperial service. These provisions allowed Mewar to enter the Mughal political order without a ritual of personal humiliation. The restriction associated with rebuilding Chittor's fortifications preserved the imperial memory of victory, showing that conciliation did not remove asymmetry.

Qualification. Military exhaustion and difficult hill warfare made accommodation rational; generosity alone did not produce it. Nor did Mewar become a simple province: the continued Rana house and internal autonomy qualify the language of conquest.

Verdict. Durability came from a credible balance - force established leverage, while status-sensitive terms made recognition sustainable.

Why this earns marks: It explains mechanism rather than narrating terms, gives three named provisions, and distinguishes suzerainty from both independence and annexation.

1615 Mewar accommodation



Rana Amar Singh accepted Mughal suzerainty



Rana excused personal attendance; Karan Singh honoured



Chittor reconstruction restriction marked imperial memory

Visual 13: deterministic revision graphic | Facts and analytical cautions are distinguished in adjacent text.

Visual 13: 1615 Mewar accommodation

Visual 13: 1615 Mewar accommodation. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 4. European diplomacy - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate the significance of Hawkins and Roe for Mughal-English commercial relations. Answer in 200 words.

Model solution

Thesis. Hawkins and Roe were significant as early experiments in access and protocol, not as founders of English territorial rule. They reveal a Company operating within Mughal sovereignty and a maritime field shaped by Portuguese competition.

Hawkins. As an English Company representative, Hawkins sought a viable trading position in the Surat world. His court experience demonstrates that personal access, gifts and Portuguese maritime pressure could affect petitions. It does not show that England had become a Mughal ally or that Surat was English-controlled.

Roe. James I's ambassador, Roe stayed from 1615 to 1619 and sought facilities, protection and status. His journal records audience, gift and rank problems, thus revealing diplomatic culture as well as commercial ambition. The 1618 farman and related permissions are best described as limited trade facilities on Mughal terms. They did not convey territory, an empire-wide monopoly or sovereign jurisdiction.

Source qualification. Roe's frustration and factory records privilege a merchant-diplomatic viewpoint; farmans and local practice are required to check scope. Swally's naval context affected bargaining but did not reverse Mughal hierarchy.

Verdict. Immediate importance was commercial and contingent; retrospective importance became greater only in a later political world.

Why this earns marks: It uses both envoys, farman scope, maritime context and source criticism, while directly rejecting teleology.

1618 farman: scope versus myth



Facilities at/for trade including Surat must be read cautiously



No exclusive empire-wide monopoly



No transfer of land, army or jurisdiction

Visual 24: deterministic revision graphic | Facts and analytical cautions are distinguished in adjacent text.

Visual 24: 1618 farman: scope versus myth

Visual 24: 1618 farman: scope versus myth. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 5. Nur Jahan's authority - 20 marks

Question: Examine Nur Jahan's political authority without reducing it either to personal rule or ceremonial influence. Answer in 250 words.

Model solution

Thesis. Nur Jahan exercised exceptional, partly formalised authority through household access, patronage, kinship and documentary visibility. This was more than ceremonial influence, but it did not replace Jahangir as sovereign.

Channels of power. Her 1611 marriage placed her within the imperial household where access to the emperor, petitions and patronage could shape political outcomes. Her father Ghiyas Beg/Itimad-ud-Daulah and brother Asaf Khan were significant elite connections; Asaf Khan's daughter Arjumand Banu married Khurram. Such links made the household politically consequential, though they did not create a permanent automatic bloc.

Public evidence. Surviving farmans in Nur Jahan's name and coins carrying a linked authority formula are crucial. A farman demonstrates formal action in a particular named context; coinage demonstrates public representation and circulation. Together they make female authority materially visible beyond anecdote. The Itimad-ud-Daulah tomb, built for her father, further anchors patronage in durable architecture.

Qualification. Documents and coins cannot quantify every appointment or prove that Jahangir was an absentee. Jahangir continued to issue decisions, direct campaigns and sustain imperial persona. Gender analysis must also avoid generalisation: Nur Jahan's authority worked through a patriarchal household and did not establish political equality for women.

Verdict. She was an exceptional power-holder whose influence became especially consequential in later crisis politics, not an empress-regnant governing a separate constitutional office.

Why this earns marks: It has a clear middle thesis, names farmans, coins, kinship and architecture, explains what each proves, and places agency within institutional and gender limits.

Farmans and coins: strong but bounded evidence

● Documents/coins show public formalisation of authority

● They do not prove a replacement sovereign

● Ask date, formula, issuer and circulation

Visual 29: deterministic revision graphic | Facts and analytical cautions are distinguished in adjacent text.

Visual 29: Farmans and coins: strong but bounded evidence

Visual 29: Farmans and coins: strong but bounded evidence. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 6. Junta debate - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine the 'Nur Jahan junta' interpretation of Jahangir's court. Answer in 200 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The junta interpretation captures the visible rise of Nur Jahan's family but fails when used as a fixed, all-explaining coalition from 1611 onward.

The claim. Beni Prasad's model groups Nur Jahan, Itimad-ud-Daulah, Asaf Khan and Khurram. It directs attention to household patronage, promotions and marriage links - real mechanisms in a personal monarchy. It also prevents an implausible picture of the imperial harem as politically sealed off.

The critique. Nurul Hasan's evidence-led objection, taken up by Satish Chandra, notes that promotions were distributed beyond the family and that contemporary proof of a stable Nur Jahan-Khurram bloc during 1611-20 is lacking. Office, service, regional affiliation, rivalry and shifting access produced multiple networks. Thus family advancement does not establish a permanent junta.

Periodisation. A better model separates 1611-21 from the post-1622 crisis. After Itimad-ud-Daulah's death, Qandahar's loss, Jahangir's illness and Khurram's rebellion, succession politics sharpened and Nur Jahan's interventions became more visibly consequential. This is active politics, but not evidence that the same four persons had monopolised every earlier decision.

Verdict. Replace a static junta with shifting factional networks around a sovereign whose household was politically important but not institutionally sovereign.

Why this earns marks: It presents Beni Prasad fairly, uses Nurul Hasan/Satish Chandra as a specific critique, periodises the evidence, and retains rather than erases Nur Jahan's influence.

Nurul Hasan / Satish Chandra critique



Promotions were distributed beyond kin



No contemporary proof of stable Nur Jahan-Khurram bloc, 1611-20



Family rise is real; static alliance is unproven

Visual 34: deterministic revision graphic | Facts and analytical cautions are distinguished in adjacent text.

Visual 34: Nurul Hasan / Satish Chandra critique

Visual 34: Nurul Hasan / Satish Chandra critique. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 7. Khurram's rebellion - 20 marks

Question: Analyse the causes and consequences of Khurram's rebellion of 1622-25. Answer in 250 words.

Model solution

Thesis. Khurram's rebellion arose from a convergence of succession anxiety, frontier command, resources and court alignment; its consequence was to sharpen a latent dynastic problem and weaken coordination without ending Mughal capacity.

Causes. Khurram's earlier Mewar and Deccan service had given him military stature and the title Shah Jahan, making succession expectations politically weighty. The Safavid seizure of Qandahar in 1622 created a command crisis: the question of marching, obedience and risk could not be detached from his fear that absence would weaken his position at court. Jagir and resource issues mattered because rank financed service and armed followings. The rise of Shahryar, strengthened by marriage to Ladli Begum, and Nur Jahan's perceived alignment with him made access to the emperor a succession issue.

Analysis. No single factor is enough. A one-cause claim that Nur Jahan 'drove out' Khurram ignores the emperor's authority, the Qandahar emergency and material bargaining; an account of resources alone ignores kinship and dynastic legitimacy.

Consequences. Campaigning against a prince diverted men and resources from frontier coordination. It intensified noble realignment and made succession alternatives more explicit. Yet imperial forces operated, negotiations remained possible and Jahangir's state did not disappear.

Verdict. The rebellion exposed the costs of a personalised monarchy with several credible princes; it is a bridge to, not a substitute for, Topic 21's succession outcome.

Why this earns marks: It analyses causation across four linked dimensions, attaches named evidence to each, and separates immediate strain from the later accession narrative.

Khurram rebellion, 1622-1625: converging causes



Qandahar command/refusal | resources and jagirs



Succession anxiety | Shahryar/Nur Jahan alignment | authority



Reject the one-cause 'Nur Jahan drove him out' story

Visual 39: deterministic revision graphic | Facts and analytical cautions are distinguished in adjacent text.

Visual 39: Khurram rebellion, 1622-1625: converging causes

Visual 39: Khurram rebellion, 1622-1625: converging causes. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 8. Mahabat Khan - 10 marks

Question: Why did Mahabat Khan's 1626 coup achieve immediate success but fail to create durable power? Answer in 150 words.

Model solution

Thesis. Mahabat Khan succeeded tactically because he captured the emperor at a vulnerable moment; he failed strategically because imperial power was wider than the emperor's physical custody.

Immediate success. During the Jhelum crossing, movement and surprise created an opening. Mahabat Khan's service network, including a Rajput contingent, enabled the seizure of Jahangir. In a ruler-centred monarchy, possession of the sovereign's person gave access to orders, audiences and the language of legitimacy.

Why it failed. The same act did not secure treasury, bureaucracy, wide noble acceptance or an alternative source of legitimacy. Accounts differ over the sequence of Nur Jahan's resistance and captivity, but they support a broader point: she could manoeuvre within household and imperial networks to detach supporters. Mahabat's coercion lacked the administrative and social breadth required to convert a coup into rule.

Verdict. The episode reveals a vulnerability of embodied sovereignty, yet its reversal proves that Mughal government was not reducible to a single armed seizure.

Why this earns marks: It directly answers the contrast, names Jhelum, Rajput support and Nur Jahan's manoeuvre, and explains the institutional gap rather than merely retelling the coup.

Nur Jahan's recovery strategy



Resistance/crossing narratives differ by source



Captivity did not end manoeuvre: supporters could be detached



Political skill worked through relationships and imperial legitimacy

Visual 44: deterministic revision graphic | Facts and analytical cautions are distinguished in adjacent text.

Visual 44: Nur Jahan's recovery strategy

Visual 44: Nur Jahan's recovery strategy. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 9. Jahangir as ruler - 15 marks

Question: Assess Jahangir as a ruler in the light of his personal reputation and political record. Answer in 200 words.

Model solution

Thesis. Jahangir's personal habits and illness shaped access to him, but the political record prevents a weak-ruler caricature. He governed through inherited institutions, public justice claims, campaigns and negotiated settlements.

Record. The Jahangirnama's twelve orders and chain of justice project a ruler attentive to rectitude and accessibility. They are evidence of political self-fashioning, not proof of universal justice. The 1615 Mewar settlement and 1620 Kangra capture show real capacity for consolidation. Composite nobility continued and jizyah was not restored, indicating broad institutional and religious-policy continuity with Akbar.

Personal reputation and culture. The memoir's natural-history observations and painting connoisseurship show an unusually observing courtly persona. Alcohol, opium and later health problems are historically relevant because they made access and household politics more consequential. They do not establish permanent abdication: Jahangir continued to rule and Nur Jahan's influence was exceptional rather than a substitute monarchy.

Qualification. Qandahar's loss, Deccan limits, Khurram's rebellion and Mahabat's coup are substantial failures or stresses. They demonstrate that consolidation was incomplete.

Verdict. Jahangir was a capable but constrained ruler whose record is best understood as continuity under escalating pressures, not as either golden calm or helpless decline.

Why this earns marks: It balances persona, sources, achievements and setbacks, and turns personal habits into a political-access argument instead of a moral judgement.

Religion: broad framework, coercive episodes

Continuation of composite nobility; no jizyah restoration

Guru Arjan episode requires context and source caution

Reject tolerant/bigot binary

Visual 47: deterministic revision graphic | Facts and analytical cautions are distinguished in adjacent text.

Visual 47: Religion: broad framework, coercive episodes

Visual 47: Religion: broad framework, coercive episodes. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.

Mains 10. Sources and overall verdict - 20 marks

Question: How should historians use the Jahangirnama, court chronicles, material evidence and European accounts to assess Jahangir's reign? Answer in 250 words.

Model solution

Thesis. A sound assessment emerges from a source-reach matrix, not from selecting one flattering or hostile narrative. Each source proves a different kind of claim.

Jahangirnama. The memoir is central for chronology, the emperor's account of Guru Arjan, the chain of justice, early orders and natural observation. It gives access to rulerly self-fashioning and reported decisions. Its limitations are equally productive: a royal claim to accessible justice is not a complaint register, and later continuation/editorial transmission means that authorship and edition must be identified.

Court and material sources. Mutamad Khan's Iqbalnama and other Persian chronicles can check sequence and provide alternative court narratives, but patronage and retrospective rhetoric matter. Nur Jahan's farmans and coins are strong evidence for formal public authority; they cannot prove total control. The Itimad-ud-Daulah tomb is durable evidence of family patronage and architectural change, not proof of a permanent junta. Paintings illuminate hierarchy and ideology, not camera-like events.

European and community sources. Roe, Hawkins and factory records show commercial negotiations, rank problems and merchant priorities. Their commercial lens cannot stand for the whole empire. Sikh traditions are indispensable to the memory and meaning of Guru Arjan's execution, while requiring chronological and genre awareness.

Verdict. Triangulation supports a graded conclusion: Jahangir's reign combined genuine consolidation with stressed frontiers and shifting court networks. It rejects the weak-ruler, total-Nur-Jahan-rule and fixed-junta shortcuts without erasing coercion or female agency.

Why this earns marks: It defines what each source can and cannot prove, uses concrete examples, and turns method into a substantive balanced verdict.

Source reach matrix

Source	Records	Can support	Cannot alone prove
Memoir	rulerly perception	chronology/persona	not transparent reality
Farman / coin	formal public authority	named act/formula	not total control
Roe / painting	encounter / ideology	commercial/visual lens	not whole governance

Visual 52: deterministic study visual | Labels are explanatory; use adjacent text for source limits.

Visual 52: Source reach matrix

Visual 52: Source reach matrix. Read it as a compact argument map; spatial diagrams marked schematic are not to scale.